stopped and all he will have learnt can only be from vague reports of the ambassadors having left and which must be calculated to deter him from acting with regard to his property under my charge, the goods are perfectly safe and in good condition. They are shipped in my name on board an English vessel floating in this bay.

It is very important Sadik Bey should know the turn affairs have taken as this must decide his future movement. I shall also be the bearer of very important news such as the change of ministry and there is also a strong report of the king's death.[3] We shall know more however by the next post which we expect daily. I set out 2 or 3 days after its arrival. My own prospects are in any case not bad — the late war must have made the Persians fully aware of the necessity of employing British officers and should all be well with Sadik Bey my interest is as good as it possibly can be. If he is lost to us I have no doubt Major Harte and the English gentlemen will consider favourably of my case. I have seen here a gentleman who has been in Persia and whose accounts are most flattering.

I think it very possible I shall have another journey back again to assist in getting in the goods which will be an affair of considerable difficulty as they can not in any case proceed until we have heard from the Persian government who must apply to the Porte for a remission of duties, leave to pass etc. I have a good deal of difficulty to look forward to in my travels not to mention the unpleasantness of being a month without seeing a Christian face or speaking a European language. I expect to set out from here in four or five days, it is uncertain whether by land or sea, should I find a good Dutch ship going up I will go with her.

You now have a rough sketch of my prospects and probable proceedings, I will proceed to give you some idea of Smirna and the way in which I have spent my time here. The town of Smirna is situated on a most beautiful bay and surrounded by fine bold mountains itself being in the valley and stretching along the sea shore. During the winter these mountains were covered with snow and the cold was severe. The town is badly and irregularly built, there is only one street in it which will allow of a carriage to pass. It is very dirty and altogether disagreeable after European cities but the country is delightful and there are a vast many pleasant villages which are partly inhabited by Turks partly by Greeks and the shooting is capital. We go out for two or three days, take provisions with us and live in one of the Greek houses and seldom fail to bring home a large quantity of woodcocks, partridges and hares.

I was once out on a similar excursion with Fowler and a Lieutenant of the Cambrian. We went to Lidigin a beautiful village distant by four hours from Smirna when there we recollected we were on the road to the far famed Ephesus

[3] Fath Ali Shah, king of Persia. The rumor was false; the Shah did not die until 1834.

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